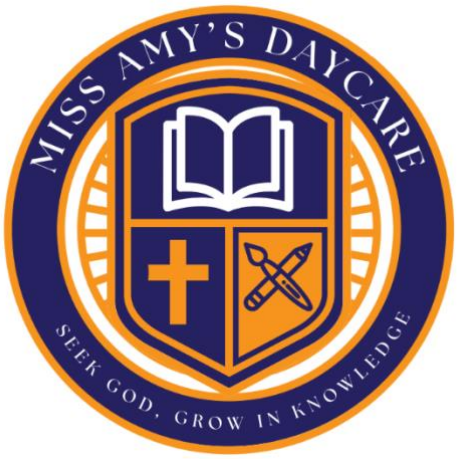

MISS AMY'S DAYCARE POLICIES AND PROCEDURES HANDBOOK

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Table of Contents

1. WELCOME FROM MISS AMY 4
2. OUR ETHOS & VALUES 5
3. OPENING HOURS 5
4. ADMISSIONS & SETTLING IN 5
5. THE KEY PERSON SYSTEM 6
6. OUR CURRICULUM (EYFS OVERVIEW) 6
7. SUPPORTING CHILDREN WITH ADDITIONAL NEEDS (SEND) 7
8. SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN 7
9. SAFEGUARDING AND CHILD PROTECTION POLICY 8
10. SAFER RECRUITMENT POLICY 12
11. STAFF CODE OF CONDUCT 12
12. ONLINE SAFETY POLICY 12
13. PREVENT DUTY & RADICALISATION 13
14. PROMOTING BRITISH VALUES 13
15. LOOKED AFTER CHILDREN POLICY 13
16. HEALTH, ILLNESS & MEDICATION 14
17. ALLERGIES & MEDICAL CONDITIONS 15
18. NUTRITION & FOOD POLICY 16
19. LATE COLLECTION & NON-COLLECTION 17
20. ATTENDANCE & ABSENCE 17
21. BUSINESS CONTINUITY & CLOSURES 18
22. PARTNERSHIP WITH PARENTS 18
23. FEES AND FUNDING POLICY 18
24. MISSING CHILD PROCEDURE 19
25. DATA PROTECTION & CONFIDENTIALITY 19
26. COMPLAINTS POLICY 19
27. WHISTLEBLOWING POLICY 19
28. EMERGENCY PROCEDURES 20
29. EQUALITY & INCLUSION 20
30. NAPPY CHANGING & TOILETING PROCEDURES 20

31. DUMMY (PACIFIER) POLICY 21
33. SUPERVISION POLICY 22
34. LOCKDOWN PROCEDURE 22
35. MONITORING & REVIEW 22
DECLARATION 23

1. WELCOME FROM MISS AMY

Dear Parents and Carers,

Welcome to Miss Amy's Daycare.

Thank you for considering our setting as part of your child's early years journey. Choosing childcare is one of the most important decisions a family makes, and we are truly honoured to play a role in your child's development.

At Miss Amy's Daycare, we believe childhood should be joyful, secure and filled with opportunity. We create a nurturing environment where children feel safe, valued and confident to explore the world around them.

Our team works hard to build strong, caring relationships with each child and family. We understand that every child is unique, and we celebrate individuality while supporting growth, independence and kindness.

This handbook outlines how we operate, what you can expect from us, and how we work together to give your child the very best start.

If you ever have questions, concerns or ideas, our door is always open.

Warm regards,
Miss Amy
Registered Provider & Daycare Manager

2. OUR ETHOS & VALUES

At Miss Amy's Daycare, we believe:

- Every child deserves to feel safe and secure.
- Strong relationships build strong learners.
- Children learn best through play.
- Families are our partners.
- Kindness and respect are central to everything we do.

We aim to create a calm, welcoming environment where children feel confident to try new things and develop independence.

3. OPENING HOURS

We are open:

Monday to Friday
8:00am – 6:00pm

We are closed on:

- Bank holidays
- Designated holiday closures (shared in advance)

Please ensure your child is collected by 6:00pm. Late collection charges apply (see Fees section).

4. ADMISSIONS & SETTLING IN

We understand that starting childcare can feel emotional for both children and parents.

4.1 Registration Process

Parents will be asked to provide:

- Completed registration form
- Emergency contact details
- Medical information
- Funding eligibility code (if applicable)

4.2 Settling-In Sessions

We offer settling-in sessions to help your child:

- Become familiar with the environment

- Build trust with their key person
- Feel safe and comfortable

Every child settles differently, and we will work with you to make the transition as smooth as possible.

5. THE KEY PERSON SYSTEM

Each child is assigned a key person who:

- Builds a secure attachment
- Observes development
- Shares progress with you
- Supports emotional wellbeing

Your key person will be your main point of contact.

6. OUR CURRICULUM (EYFS OVERVIEW)

We follow the Early Years Foundation Stage (EYFS).

Children learn through play across seven areas of learning:

Prime Areas:

- Personal, Social and Emotional Development
- Communication and Language
- Physical Development

Specific Areas:

- Literacy
- Mathematics
- Understanding the World
- Expressive Arts and Design

We focus on:

- Curiosity
- Confidence
- Independence
- Kindness
- School readiness

Learning is playful, engaging and tailored to children's interests.

7. SUPPORTING CHILDREN WITH ADDITIONAL NEEDS (SEND)

We are committed to inclusion.

If your child needs additional support:

- We will discuss concerns sensitively.
- We will create a support plan.
- We will work closely with you.
- We may liaise with external professionals (with consent).

Early support helps children thrive.

8. SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN

Your child's safety is our highest priority.

We follow national safeguarding guidance and Southwark safeguarding procedures.

If we ever have concerns about a child's safety, we have a legal duty to act in the child's best interest.

This may include:

- Recording concerns
- Seeking advice
- Contacting appropriate services

We will always prioritise children's welfare.

9. SAFEGUARDING AND CHILD PROTECTION POLICY

9.1 Policy Statement

Miss Amy's Daycare is fully committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of every child in our care. We recognise that children have the right to be protected from harm, abuse, neglect, exploitation and radicalisation.

Safeguarding underpins everything we do. It is embedded in our culture, recruitment practices, supervision systems, behaviour management, curriculum delivery and daily routines.

We understand that:

- Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility
- Early identification of concerns is critical
- Children may not always disclose abuse directly
- The child's welfare is paramount

We work in partnership with parents, professionals and the Southwark Safeguarding Children Partnership to ensure children are safe and supported.

9.2 Definition of Safeguarding

Safeguarding includes:

- Protecting children from maltreatment
- Preventing impairment of children's mental and physical health
- Ensuring safe, naturing and effective care
- Taking early action where concerns arise
- Supporting families to prevent escalation

Safeguarding is broader than child protection. It includes:

- Health and safety
- Safe recruitment
- Online safety
- Staff behaviour standards
- Attendance monitoring
- Emotional wellbeing
- Risk assessment

Child protection refers specifically to action taken where a child is suffering or likely to suffer significant harm.

9.3 Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)

The Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL) has overall responsibility for safeguarding.

The DSL:

- Receives all safeguarding concerns
- Makes threshold decisions
- Liaises with Southwark MASH
- Contacts LADO where necessary
- Maintains confidential safeguarding records
- Ensures staff training compliance
- Monitors safeguarding culture
- Ensures Prevent compliance
- Overseas safer recruitment

Designated Safeguarding Lead:
Amy Jabbie- Nursery Manager

- Holds Level 3 Safeguarding Training
- Training refreshed every 2 years
- Annual safeguarding updates completed

The DSL ensures safeguarding is discussed regularly in staff meetings and supervision sessions. All staff complete safeguarding training appropriate to their role.

9.4 Southwark Safeguarding Contacts

Southwark Children's Social Care (MASH)
020 7525 1921

Emergency Duty Team (Out of Hours)
020 7525 5000

LADO (Allegations Against Staff)
Via Southwark Children's Services

If a child is in immediate danger: 999

9.5 Recognising Abuse

Staff are trained to recognise possible indicators including:

- **Physical abuse**
  - Unexplained bruises or marks
  - Injuries inconsistent with explanation
  - Fear of going home

- **Emotional abuse**
  - Excessive withdrawal
  - Low self-esteem
  - Delayed emotional development
  - Extreme behaviour

- **Sexual abuse**
  - Sexualised behaviour inappropriate for age
  - Knowledge beyond developmental level
  - Reluctance to change clothing

- **Neglect**
  - Poor hygiene
  - Inadequate clothing
  - Persistent hunger
  - Untreated medical issues

- **Domestic abuse**
  - Frequent unexplained injuries or inconsistent explanations
  - Child appears fearful of a parent/carer
  - Anxiety, hypervigilance, or “on edge” behaviour
  - Aggressive behaviour or extreme withdrawal
  - Poor attendance or lateness
  - Parent overly controlling or speaks for the child
  - Child describes violent incidents at home
  - Regression in younger children (bedwetting, clinginess)

- **Honour Based Violence**
  - Strict control over child’s social interaction
  - Child expressing fear of “being naughty” or bringing shame
  - Family discouraging interaction with certain children
  - Sudden withdrawal from nursery without explanation
  - Older siblings previously removed from education

- **Forced Marriage**
  - Siblings married at a young age
  - Family discussing marriage plans for older siblings
  - Frequent long trips abroad with vague explanations
  - Statements about girls’ limited future roles

- **Female Genital Mutilation (FGM)**
  - Child talking about a “special ceremony” or party
  - Extended holiday to a country with known prevalence
  - Difficulty sitting, standing, or walking
  - Crying during toileting
  - Blood stains in underwear
  - Frequent urinary infections
  - Disclosure by sibling or parent

- **Child Criminal Exploitation**
  - Older siblings involved in gangs or criminal activity
  - Child left unsupervised frequently
  - Normalisation of violence in play
  - Parent/carer involved in substance misuse
  - Exposure to unsafe adults collecting the child

- **County Lines**
  - Unknown adults attending the home address (reported by parent or observed)
  - Parent appearing fearful or controlled
  - Child discussing "people coming to the house at night."
  - Safeguarding concerns linked to older siblings

- **Radicalisation**
  - Child repeating extreme or violent language heard at home
  - Play themes focused on weapons or violence beyond typical developmental play
  - Intolerance language ("they are bad people") repeatedly reinforced
  - Sudden isolation from other children due to parental views

- **Online abuse**
  - Knowledge of sexualised language inappropriate for age
  - Imitating explicit behaviours in play
  - Fearful reactions to certain sounds or images
  - Talking about online "friends."
  - Distress when a device is removed

Staff understand that one indicator alone does not confirm abuse, but patterns or concerns must be recorded factually and reported to the DSL immediately.

9.6 Reporting Procedure

If a concern arises:

1. Staff member listens calmy and does not promise confidentiality
2. Concern is recorded verbatim where possible
3. DSL informed immediately
4. DSL reviews using Southwark threshold guidance
5. Referral made without delay if required
6. Ofsted notified within required timeframe (if applicable)

If a child is at immediate risk of harm, police are contacted first.

We do not conduct interviews or investigations.

9.7 Low-Level Concerns

Low-level concerns may include:

- Inappropriate tone

- Boundary crossing
- Favourtism
- Minor professional judgement concerns

These are:

- Logged securely
- Reviewed for patterns
- Addressed through supervision

10. SAFER RECRUITMENT POLICY

We follow robust safer recruitment practices:

- Enhanced DBS before employment
- Identity checks (photo ID and proof of address)
- Two verified references
- Employment history checks
- Disqualification declaration under Childcare Act
- Right to work verification
- Health declaration

No staff member works unsupervised without appropriate clearance. Induction includes safeguarding, Prevent and code of conduct training.

11. STAFF CODE OF CONDUCT

Staff must:

- Maintain professional relationships
- Avoid lone situations without visibility
- Use respectful language
- Not engage in personal relationships with parents
- Not discuss confidential information outside setting
- Use social media responsibly

Breaches are managed through disciplinary procedures.

12. ONLINE SAFETY POLICY

We:

- Use filtered and monitored internet systems
- Restrict children's access to online content
- Prohibit personal device use during sessions
- Lock devices securely when not in use

- Report online exploitation concerns to CEOP

To protect children:

- Parents must not post photos of other children.
- Staff do not accept parents on personal social media accounts.
- Nursery matters should not be discussed online.

We prioritise privacy and professionalism.

13. PREVENT DUTY & RADICALISATION

Under the Counterterrorism and Security Act 2015 we have due regard to prevent people from being drawn into terrorism.

We:

- Train staff to recognise radicalisation
- Complete Prevent risk assessments
- Promote British Values
- Refer concerns to Channel via Southwark

14. PROMOTING BRITISH VALUES

Embedded through EYFS areas of:

- Personal, Social and Emotional Development
- Understanding the World

We promote:

- **Democracy**
  - Children vote on activities
- **Rule of Law**
  - Clear boundaries and consistent rules
- **Individual Liberty**
  - Children make choices within safe limits
- **Mutual Respect**
  - Kindness modelled by staff
- **Tolerance**
  - Celebration of cultural diversity

Intolerance or discrimination is not accepted.

15. LOOKED AFTER CHILDREN POLICY

We:

- Work in partnership with Social Workers
- Contribute to Personal Education Plans (PEP)

- Liaise with Southwark Virtual School Head
- Support attachment and resilience

Confidentiality is strictly maintained.

16. HEALTH, ILLNESS & MEDICATION

We:

- Complete medical care plans
- Record accidents accurately
- Notify parents immediately
- Maintain first aid kits
- Ensure at least one Paediatric First Aider present

The health and wellbeing of all children in our care is extremely important.

To protect everyone, we follow clear illness and exclusion guidance.

Please do not bring your child to nursery if they have:

- A high temperature
- Vomiting or diarrhoea (48-hour exclusion after last episode)
- Contagious illness (e.g. chickenpox in infectious stage)
- Severe cold or flu symptoms
- Unexplained rash

If your child becomes unwell during the day:

- We will contact you immediately.
- You may be asked to collect your child.
- Children must be collected promptly when unwell.

Our aim is always to keep all children safe and comfortable.

Parents must collect within 90 minutes if contacted.

16.1 Medication

We can only administer prescribed medication.

Medication must:

- Be in original packaging
- Clearly labelled with child's name
- Include dosage instructions

Parents must complete and sign a medication consent form.

Two members of staff will check medication where appropriate.

We cannot administer non-prescribed medication unless agreed under exceptional circumstances.

For conditions such as:

- Severe allergies (EpiPen)
- Asthma (inhaler)
- Epilepsy (emergency medication)

We ensure:

- Medication is easily accessible
- Staff are trained in its use
- Expiry dates are monitored

If emergency medication is administered, we will:

- Call emergency services if required
- Inform parents immediately

17. ALLERGIES & MEDICAL CONDITIONS

If your child has allergies or dietary needs:

- Please inform us during registration.
- Provide medical evidence where required.
- Ensure medication (e.g. EpiPen) is supplied and in date.

We take allergies extremely seriously and follow strict food preparation procedures.

At registration, parents must inform us of:

- Any diagnosed medical condition
- Allergies (food or environmental)
- Asthma
- Epilepsy
- Diabetes
- Eczema requiring treatment
- Any regular medication
- Any hospital care plans

It is essential that information is accurate and updated immediately if anything changes.

If your child has long-term or serious medication condition/s, we will create an Individual Heath Care Plan.

This will include:

- The condition and symptoms
- Known triggers
- Medication required
- Emergency procedures
- Contact details
- Parent and staff responsibilities.

This plan will be reviewed regularly with you.

18. NUTRITION & FOOD POLICY

We are committed to promoting healthy eating habits and positive attitudes towards food.

Meal and snack times are valued as important learning opportunities and social experiences.

We provide balanced, nutritious food that supports children's growth, development and wellbeing.

18.1 Healthy Eating Principles

- Meals are balanced and age-appropriate.
- Fresh fruit and vegetables are offered daily.
- Fresh drinking water is available at all times.
- Food is low in salt and added sugar.
- We accommodate allergies, medical needs and religious requirements.
- Food hygiene standards are strictly followed.

18.2 Learning Through Food

Children are encouraged to:

- Try new foods.
- Develop independence during mealtimes.
- Serve themselves where appropriate.
- Practice table manners.
- Explore food through cooking and sensory activities.
- Learn about healthy lifestyles.

Food-based activities may include:

- Cooking experiences
- Food tasting
- Growing herbs or vegetables
- Exploring food textures
- Cultural food celebrations

18.3 Mealtime Environment

We aim to create a calm and social environment where:

- Staff sit with children during meals.
- Conversation is encouraged.
- Children are never forced to eat.
- Positive modelling of healthy choices takes place.

18.4 Food Safety & Hygiene

- Staff hold appropriate food hygiene training.
- Surfaces are cleaned before and after food preparation.
- Cross-contamination is prevented.
- Dietary information is clearly displayed in food preparation areas.

19. LATE COLLECTION & NON-COLLECTION

We understand that delays sometimes happen.

However, if you are late collecting your child:

- A charge of £3 per minute applies after 6:00pm.
- Please call immediately if delayed.

Persistent late collection may result in review of your child's place.

If a child is not collected:

1. Attempt to contact parent
2. Contact emergency contacts
3. After one hour, contact Children's Social Care

Ofsted will be informed where appropriate.

20. ATTENDANCE & ABSENCE

Regular attendance supports your child's development and routine.

If your child will be absent:

- Please inform us as soon as possible.
- Unexplained absence will be followed up.

We monitor attendance to ensure safeguarding and continuity.

21. BUSINESS CONTINUITY & CLOSURES

In rare cases of emergency closure (e.g. severe weather or utility failure):

- Parents will be informed as early as possible.
- Safety decisions will always come first.

22. PARTNERSHIP WITH PARENTS

We value strong relationships with families.

We will:

- Share regular feedback
- Discuss progress
- Communicate concerns early
- Welcome your input

You are always welcome to speak with us.

Open communication helps children thrive.

23. FEES AND FUNDING POLICY

We offer both funded and non-funded places.

23.1 Funded Hours

We offer:

- 15-hour universal entitlement
- 30-hour extended entitlement

Funded hours cover childcare provision only.

Meals are charged separately at £3 per day.

23.2 Fee Payments

- Invoices are issued monthly.
- Payment must be made by the due date.
- Bank transfer is preferred.

Late payments may incur additional charges.

24. MISSING CHILD PROCEDURE

If a child goes missing:

- Secure other children
- Conduct immediate search
- Contact police
- Inform parents
- Inform Ofsted
- Review and risk assessment conducted

Full incident report completed.

25. DATA PROTECTION & CONFIDENTIALITY

We respect your family's privacy.

All records are:

- Stored securely
- Accessed only by authorised staff
- Shared only when legally required

We comply with UK GDPR and data protection legislation.

26. COMPLAINTS POLICY

Parents should:

1. Raise concerns verbally
2. Submit written complaint if unresolved

Written response provided within 28 days.

Parents may contact:

Ofsted
0300 123 1231

27. WHISTLEBLOWING POLICY

Staff can report concerns:

- Internally to DSL
- To Ofsted
- To Southwark Children's Services

No staff member will suffer detriment for raising concerns.

28. EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

In the event of:

- Fire
- Power failure
- Severe weather
- Unexpected closure

We will:

- Ensure children's safety
- Contact parents immediately
- Follow our emergency procedures

Children regularly practice fire drills so they feel confident and safe.

29. EQUALITY & INCLUSION

We comply with Equality Act 2010.

We:

- Do not discriminate
- Make reasonable adjustments
- Promote diversity
- Challenge stereotypes

30. NAPPY CHANGING & TOILETING PROCEDURES

We promote children's dignity, comfort and independence at all times. Nappy changing and toileting routines are carried out in a safe, hygienic and respectful manner in line with EYFS Safeguarding and Welfare Requirements.

All staff are trained in intimate care procedures and safeguarding practice.

We:

- Respect children's dignity
- Gain parental consent
- Record incidents
- Support toilet training sensitively

30.1 Nappy Changing

- Children are changed according to their individual needs and routines.
- Nappy changes are recorded appropriately for children under 3.
- A child is never left unattended on a changing mat.
- Disposable gloves and aprons are worn for every change.
- A clean pair of gloves and apron are used for each child.
- Changing areas are cleaned thoroughly after each use.
- Staff wash hands before and after every nappy change.
- Soiled nappies are double-bagged and disposed of hygienically.
- We do not make negative comments about nappy contents.
- We do not make inappropriate comments about children's bodies.

30.2 Toileting

We support children to become confident and independent in toileting when they are developmentally ready.

- Children are encouraged, never pressured.
- We work in partnership with parents during toilet training.
- Pull-ups or training pants may be introduced when appropriate.
- Children are encouraged to wipe, flush and wash hands independently (with support).
- Soap and running water are always available.
- We allow children time to explore handwashing routines positively.
- Anti-bacterial products are not routinely used for young children unless clinically advised.

Accidents are managed calmly and discreetly to protect children's self-esteem.

31. DUMMY (PACIFIER) POLICY

We recognise that dummies may provide comfort, particularly during transitions or sleep times. However, prolonged dummy use can impact speech development, oral muscle development and social interaction.

We work in partnership with parents to support healthy dummy use.

31.1 Use of Dummies in Nursery

- Dummies are permitted for sleep or comfort when a child is distressed.
- Dummies are not used during active play or learning time.
- Each dummy must be clearly labelled.
- Dummies are stored in individual hygienic containers.
- If dropped, dummies are immediately cleaned or sterilised.

32.2 Supporting Reduction of Dummy Use

Where appropriate, staff will:

- Encourage children to store dummies in a designated place.
- Provide comfort through alternative methods (cuddles, toys, reassurance).
- Gently explain when the dummy can be used (e.g., sleep time only).
- Work with parents to gradually reduce daytime dummy use.

Our approach is always gentle, respectful and child-centered.

33. SUPERVISION POLICY

Staff receive:

- Regular supervision
- Annual appraisal
- Safeguarding updates
- Ongoing professional development

34. LOCKDOWN PROCEDURE

In event of threat:

- Secure doors
- Curtains/ blinds closed
- Children moved away from windows
- Silent environment maintained
- Emergency services contacted
- Parents updated when safe

Practice drills are conducted annually.

35. MONITORING & REVIEW

All policies are:

- Reviewed annually
- Updated in line with legislation
- Shared with parents

DECLARATION

Miss Amy's Daycare is committed to maintaining the highest safeguarding standards and ensuring full compliance with EYFS 2024 and Southwark Safeguarding procedures. This handbook is reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes.

We are committed to continuous improvement.